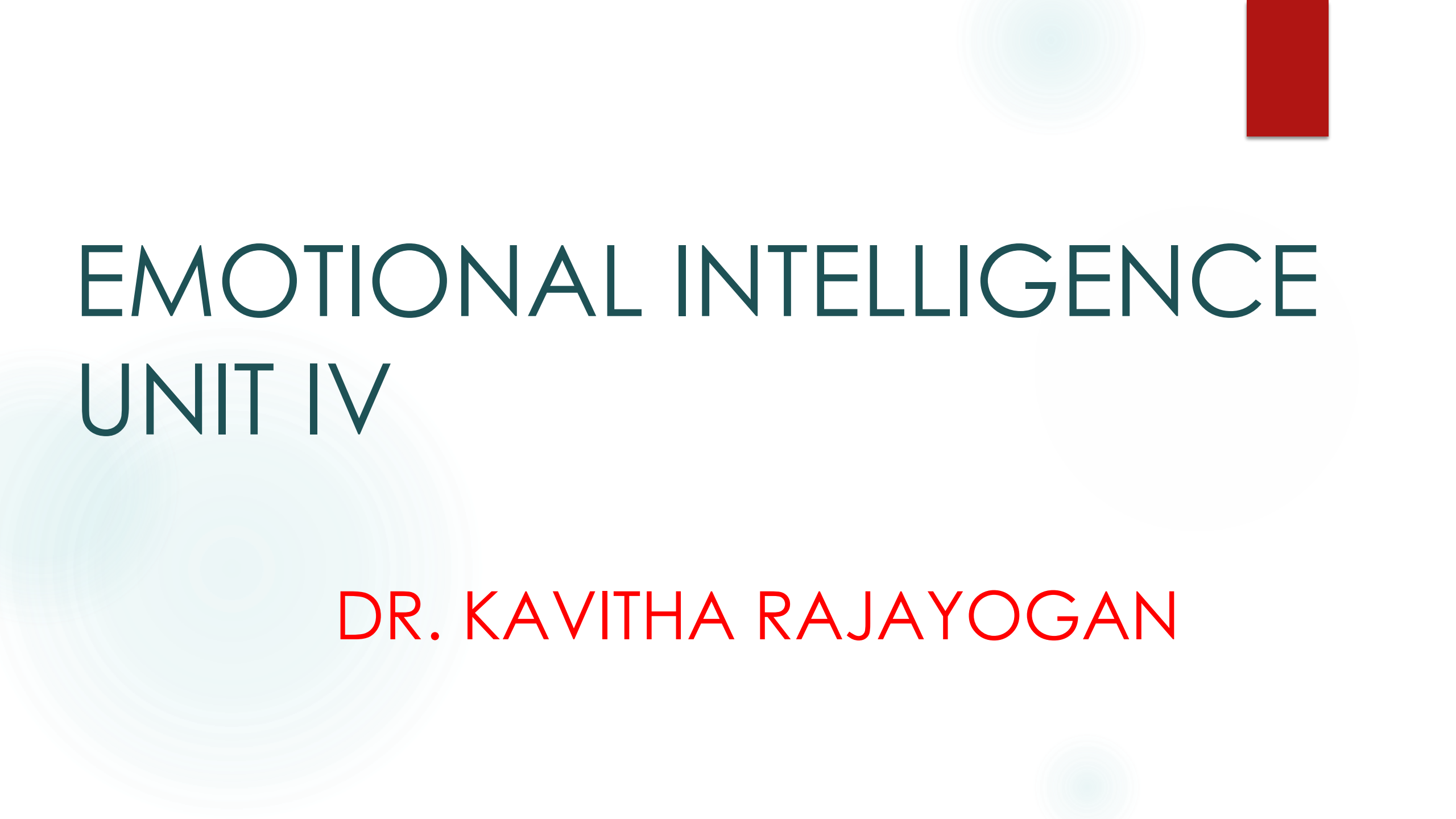




EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

UNIT IV

DR. KAVITHA RAJAYOGAN

UNIT IV

- ▶ **EI and personal effectiveness:** Flexibility, Stress Tolerance, Optimism. General Mood: Happiness. Emotional Intelligence in the Workplace: Applying Emotional Intelligence in the Workplace, Performance in the business environment. How to handle the stress/depression at home being unemployed-causes, techniques and remedies.

EI and Personal Effectiveness

- Emotional Intelligence (EI) is a critical driver of personal effectiveness, with **flexibility**, **stress tolerance**, and **optimism** serving as key competencies that enable individuals to thrive under pressure, adapt to change, and maintain high performance.
- These traits allow individuals to manage their emotions constructively, leading to better decision-making, improved relationships, and greater resilience.



Flexibility (Adaptability)

- **Definition:** The ability to adjust one's emotions, thoughts, and behaviors to changing conditions and unexpected obstacles.
- **Impact on Effectiveness:** Flexible individuals view change as an opportunity rather than a threat, which reduces anxiety and enhances job performance. It allows for shifting strategies when initial approaches fail, strengthening problem-solving skills.
- **EI Connection:** Flexibility acts as a, supporting other emotional competencies by preventing rigid, overwhelmed responses to stress.

Workplace Flexibility (Adaptability)

- Workplace flexibility allows employees to customize when, where, and how they work, moving beyond traditional 9-to-5 office roles to improve work-life balance.
- This approach boosts productivity, reduces burnout, and acts as a key retention tool for employers.

Common Types of Workplace Flexibility

- **Remote Work:** Working from home or outside the traditional office.
- **Hybrid Models:** A mix of in-office and remote working.
- **Flexible Scheduling:** Choosing start and finish times to fit personal needs, such as school pick-ups.
- **Compressed Workweeks:** Working longer hours over fewer days, such as a 4-day workweek.
- **Job Sharing:** Two or more employees sharing one full-time position
- **Unlimited paid time off (PTO):** Giving employees the freedom to take time off as needed, without a set limit on vacation days.

Workplace Flexibility (Adaptability)

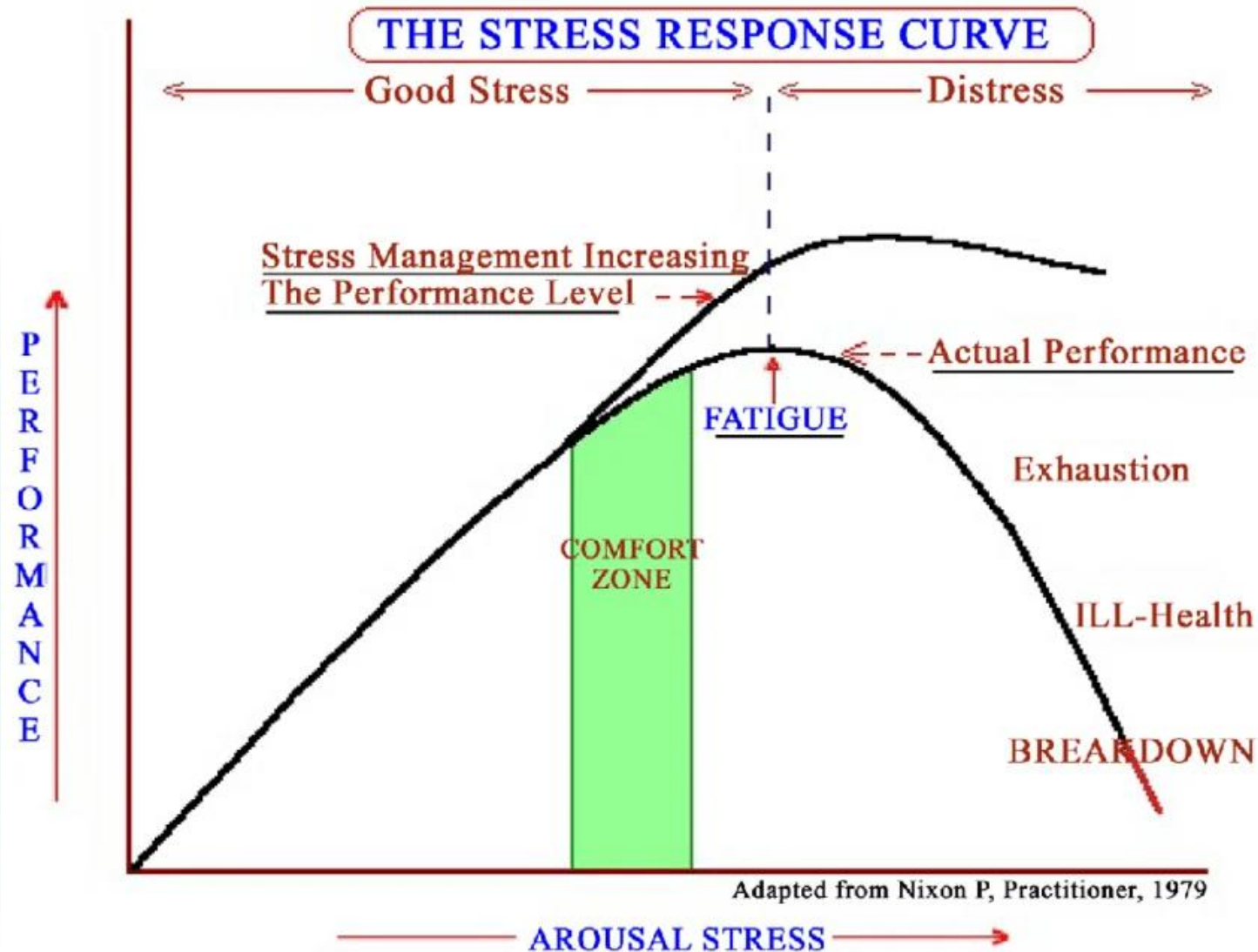


Stress Tolerance (Resilience)

- **Definition:** The capacity to remain steady and effective under pressure, managing emotions to avoid becoming overwhelmed.
- **Impact on Effectiveness:** High stress tolerance is negatively related to burnout. It involves constructive, active coping rather than passive detachment.
- **EI Connection:** It allows individuals to utilize emotions in a controlled manner, fostering a calm manner that facilitates rational decision-making during crises.



Stress Response Curve



Optimism (Positive Outlook)

- **Definition:** The ability to remain hopeful, positive, and look at the brighter side of life, even in challenging situations.
- **Impact on Effectiveness:** Optimism is closely linked to higher life satisfaction and motivation. It drives resilience, allowing individuals to persist in the face of setbacks.
- **El Connection:** It is a core component of personal well-being that helps individuals maintain a proactive mindset, supporting motivation and engagement in both personal and professional spheres.

General Mood : Happiness in Workplace

- Staying happier at work involves cultivating positive relationships, setting clear goals, practicing gratitude, and prioritizing well-being through breaks and self-care.
- Boosting workplace happiness improves productivity, reduces turnover, and fosters a healthier company culture, benefiting both employees and organizations

General Mood : Happiness in Workplace

- Staying happy at the workplace isn't about ignoring problems—it's about building habits, mindset, and environment that support your well-being and productivity
 - ✓ Start Your Day with a Positive Intention
 - ✓ Build Good Relationships
 - ✓ Find Meaning in Your Work
 - ✓ Stay Organized
 - ✓ Take Short Breaks
 - ✓ Manage Stress Smartly
 - ✓ Maintain Work-Life Balance



Emotional Intelligence in Workplace

- ▶ Emotional Intelligence (EI) in the Workplace refers to the ability to understand, manage, and use emotions effectively—both your own and others’—to improve work performance, relationships, and decision-making.
- ▶ EI is the capacity to:
 - ❖ Recognize your emotions
 - ❖ Control your reactions
 - ❖ Understand others’ feelings
 - ❖ Handle workplace situations wisely

Benefits of Emotional Intelligence in Workplace

- ❑ Working towards the organization's goals regardless of obstacles that arise.
- ❑ Greater motivation among staff to understand their own emotions and those of their colleagues.
- ❑ Healthy communication that produces common goals across the business.
- ❑ The workforce having a positive outlook when it comes to the job at hand.
- ❑ Positive relationships and deeper connections between employees.
- ❑ Flexibility; high EI means employees can respond to change effectively and handle any additional stress it brings.
- ❑ Improved efficiencies with empathetic staff making decisions based on what is best for everyone involved.
- ❑ Career progression, staff with high EI are likely to excel in leadership positions.

Impact on Business Performance

- ❑ Applying EI leads to measurable improvements in organizations
 - ❖ Better Team Performance
 - ❖ Improved Leadership Effectiveness
 - ❖ Higher Employee Satisfaction
 - ❖ Effective Conflict Management
 - ❖ Enhanced Customer Relationships

Real-Life Workplace Example

□ A team leader with high EI:

- ❖ Listens to employees
- ❖ Handles criticism positively
- ❖ Motivates the team
- ❖ Resolves conflicts calmly

Stress

- ❑ **Stress** can be defined as our mental, physical, emotional, and behavioral reactions to any perceived demands or threats.
- ❑ **Kinds of Stress**
 - ✓ **Distress** is a continuous experience of feeling overwhelmed, oppressed, and behind in our responsibilities. It is the all encompassing sense of being imposed upon by difficulties with no light at the end of the tunnel.
 - ✓ **Eustress** is the other form of stress that is positive and beneficial. We may feel challenged, but the sources of the stress are opportunities that are meaningful to us. Eustress helps provide us with energy and motivation to meet our responsibilities and achieve our goals.

What makes something Stressful?

- ❑ Situations that have strong demands
- ❑ Situations that are coming up
- ❑ Life transitions
- ❑ Timing (e.g., deviation from the “norm”)
- ❑ Ambiguity
- ❑ Desirability
- ❑ Controllability

Major Causes of Stress



Individual Consequences of Stress

Psychological

- Anxiety
- Depression
- Low self-esteem
- Sleeplessness
- Frustration
- Family problems
- Burnout



Stress

Behavioral

- Excessive smoking
- Substance abuse
- Accident proneness
- Appetite disorders
- Violence

Physiological

- High blood pressure
- Muscle tension
- Headaches
- Ulcers, skin diseases
- Impaired immune systems
- Musculoskeletal disorders
- Heart disease
- Cancer

Organisational Consequences of Stress

- Absenteeism
- Diminished productivity
- Compensation claims
- Loss of Interest and more of switching
- Harmful to organizations image
- Way to go to loss and shut down

Techniques of Managing Stress / Remedies of Stress

➤ **Organisational Strategies**

- ✓ Job redesign – Modifying job roles to reduce workload
- ✓ Flexible Work Arrangements – Work from home / flexible hours
- ✓ Positive Workplace Culture – Supportive environment
- ✓ Wellness Programs – Yoga, counseling and physical health
- ✓ Environmental Improvements – Workspace design and facilities

➤ **Individual Techniques**

- ✓ Time Management – Prioritizing the tasks
- ✓ Relaxation Techniques – Meditation, deep breathing
- ✓ Physical Activity – Exercise, walking, yoga
- ✓ Social Support Systems – Talking to family, friends and colleagues
- ✓ Cognitive Restructuring – Changing negative thinking to positive thinking



THANK YOU